Grief Comes in Stages. Here is a drop

Steven D. Powell — November 11, 2026



(Cover image painted by Muse for this essay.)

Grief comes out a little bit at a time. While still a couple of months away (Jan 1) Mom's birthday is fast approaching. As I prepare to start my MIS, i've been thinking a lot about Mom and Dad in recent weeks. Both would have I think outright cried at my finally going back. Dad especially. While I can only dream that I am as smart as he was, as clever, as able to deal with the unsual with calm and grace (at least visibly) Dad never applied to college when he was young not beliveing 'he was smart enough'. He did later. Go to community college in our home town and got I think 2 AA's one in Physics and the other in Computer Science. He work the whole time as a telecommuncaitons engr for the State of California, retired at 40 years. Dad I'm doing it now, with an MIS and a 30 year career behind me. Hope I do as well.

Mom, my biggest supporter. The one that kept telling me I should go back, telling me and anyone that would listen how smart I was. I don't think I beleived it all those times you tried

to tell me in person I was smart enough. But I just listened to a few old voicemails of yours. Nice to hear your voice... But I heard it this time, even tho you didn't say it in those message.

December 15th

Author's comment

Dad never got to meet the boys. He passed in 2006, before either of them was born. Mom did. She got to know both of them, and they got to know her.

The other night I checked a telescope out from the library and showed the boys the sky. Dad's project was a radio telescope, and we're bringing that back too. He'll meet them that way. It's the best I can do, and I think he'd take it.